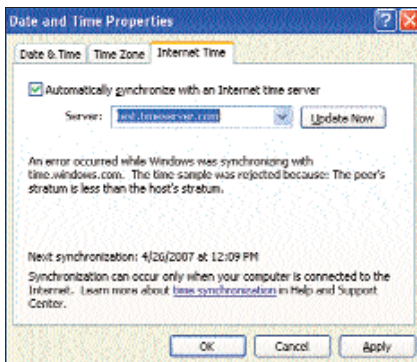




Get your PC to tell time better

"Automatically synchronize with an Internet time server" to enable it. At times, the servers may be down. To add servers, in the Registry Editor, browse to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\DateTime\Servers. Here, create new String Values with names like 3, 4, and so on. Double-click on them to enter the Value(s), and enter the server address(es).

Windows Hard Drive Optimisation

Windows has a system idle process that optimizes your hard drive using when you're away from the PC. In the Registry Editor, browse to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\OptimalLayout. Add a new key by right-clicking in the right pane and clicking New > DWORD Value. Name it "EnableAutoLayout", and give it the value "1".

Set Windows To Use Memory

Windows often spills data over into the page file even when there's free memory available, which can cause a drop in performance. You can't entirely rectify this, but you can do the following to reduce the number of accesses to the page file. In the Registry Editor, browse to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Session Manager\Memory Management. Double-click on the DWORD "DisablePagingExecutive" and change its value to 1.

Unload DLLs From System Memory

After a certain amount of time, Windows starts caching DLLs into memory, which can be a waste. You can get Windows to automatically unload the DLLs. Start the Registry Editor and browse to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\. Create a new key called "AlwaysUnloadDLL". Change the (default) string value to "1".

Hide And Show Accounts

Every account created on Windows XP will show up on the logon screen. If certain accounts are inactive, you can hide them from just the logon screen. In the Registry Editor, browse to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon\SpecialAccounts\UserList. Here, for every account you want to hide, right-click in the right pane and select New > DWORD. Give it the exact name of the account. Double-click on it and set a value of "1" to show it or "0" to hide it. Administrator accounts are usually hidden; you can enable the Administrator account in a similar manner.

Limit Logon Hours For Users

Parents might want to limit their children's computer usage, so they can set a time limit only between which they will be automatically allowed to log into their Windows account. Limited usage for particular users for certain time periods can be set through commands. The command for doing this is:

```
net user <Username> /time:<Parameters>.
For example, "net user DIGIT /time:M-
F,08:00-17:00" will only let the user
DIGIT log in between 8 and 5 from
Monday to Friday.
```

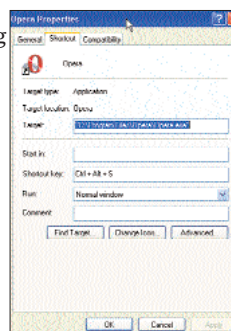
Remove Windows Messenger

Most people use Windows Live Messenger (MSN) instead of Windows Messenger, and the latter can often be an annoyance. You can remove Windows Messenger by typing the following command at a command prompt: `rundll32 setupapi,InstallHinfSection BLC.Remove 128 %SystemRoot%\INF\msmsgs.inf`

Assign A Shortcut Key To Any Program

Any program can be launched using the keyboard by assigning a shortcut key to it.

Right click the program's shortcut (the program to which you want to assign a shortcut key). In Properties, under the Shortcut tab, "Shortcut key" is, by default, "none". Just click in the box and chose an alphanumeric key to be assigned as the shortcut key. Windows will assign [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [(Alphanumeric Key)] as the shortcut key.



Shortcuts to anything

Shutdown, Restart, And Logoff Icons On The Desktop

You might want to have shortcuts on the Desktop for shutdown, hibernation, etc.

Right-click on the Desktop and make a new shortcut by selecting New > Shortcut.

Then in the Type the location of the item: box, enter "shutdown.exe -s -t 00", where "00" is the delay in seconds. (You can increase it.) You will then be asked to select a name (call it "Shutdown", for example).

After creating the shortcut, you can change the icon assigned to it by right-clicking on the shortcut and selecting Properties. The window that comes up next has a "Change Icon" option, which is easy to use.

For a Restart shortcut, use "shutdown.exe -r -t 00". Replacing -r by -l gives the code for logging off: "shutdown.exe -l -t 00". Fast user switching is also possible; the code for that is "Rundll32.exe User32.dll, LockWorkStation". Similarly one can also make a shortcut for Standby/Hibernation. If Hibernation is enabled, the computer will hibernate, else it will go into Standby. For this, use "%windir%\system32\rundll32.exe PowrProf.dll, SetSuspendState".

Get Rid Of The Windows Update "Restart Later"

To get rid of that nag screen, run the command "gpedit.msc" to launch the Group Policy Editor. Navigate to Local Computer Policy > Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Windows Update. Select "Re-prompt for restart with scheduled installations", right-click on it, and choose Properties. Check the enable option, and select the restart interval (in minutes) to be long enough not to bother you.

Restore The Show Desktop Icon

Did you know you can "Show Desktop" by using [Windows] + [D]? That apart, sometimes, the Show Desktop icon in the Quick Launch bar goes missing. The following is the manual method to re-create the Show Desktop icon. Copy the following into Notepad:

```
[Shell]
Command=2
IconFile=explorer.exe,3
[Taskbar]
Command=ToggleDesktop
```

Save this file as "Show Desktop.scf", and then drag it to the Quick Launch bar. You can even use the Regsvr32 command for the same thing. At a command prompt, type in the following: `regsvr32 /n /i:U shell32.dll`

The Show Desktop icon should now be visible in the Quick Launch bar.